

rather dial down the dollars I need to devote to school fees, which will allow me to spend more time with my kids (and make me less stressed to boot!).

Having said that, it's your life. If you want to put some of the money from your investment bond into school fees, do it. But this is one expense the kids don't have to contribute to themselves. You're carrying this one.

What about saving for their uni?

I'm not paying for my kids' uni.

Australia has one of the best university debt arrangements in the world—HECS-HELP. Remember, the HECS-HELP debt is not charged an interest rate. Instead, each year on 1 June it's indexed to the cost of living. And, since 2017 the Government has scrapped both the 10 per cent upfront payment discount and the 5 per cent voluntary repayment bonus. In other words, there's no added incentive to repay early.

My view? Let them pay their own uni fees in their own good time.

Money Meal 'shopping list'

Review the options for your Barefoot Ladder Fund:

- Generation Life LifeBuilder Bond—genlife.com.au
- AMP Growth Bond—amp.com.au/personal/investments/products/investments/growth-bond
- Australian Unity Lifeplan Investment Bond—australianunity.com.au/wealth/investment-bonds/lifeplan-products/investment-bond
- ING Orange Everyday Youth—ing.com.au
- Vanguard Australia—vanguard.com.au
- AFIC—afi.com.au